

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠Q

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣3

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠5

Board: 4

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥5

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥8

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 3 2

♥ 9 5

♦ J 6 4 3

♣ 9 3

♠ A K 5

♥ 10 7 4 3

♦ A 9 8 2

♣ K Q



♠ Q J

♥ Q J 6 2

♦ 10 7 5

♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ 7 6 4

♥ A K 8

♦ K Q

♣ A J 10 7 4

This is another example of "She who knows, goes."

SOUTH has a solid 18 points, (1 extra for the fifth Club), so when NORTH opens 1NT she KNOWS that together they must hold at least 33 points. They may even have 35 points.

In any case they should be in slam, so SOUTH GOES to 6NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♠Q

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 6 3
♥ 10 8 5
♦ A 7 3
♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ 8 5 4

♥ K 7 6 4

♦ 8 6 2

♣ A J 6



♠ K J 9

♥ A Q

♦ K Q J 9 5

♣ K 10 4

♠ A Q 7 2

♥ J 9 3 2

♦ 10 4

♣ 7 3 2

EAST has 20 points, counting one extra for the fifth Diamond. Just right to open 2NT.

WEST has 6 points, just enough to bid 3NT. (20 + 6 = 26) (21 + 6 = 27)

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣3

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 5 4

♥ 5 3

♦ K J 7 5

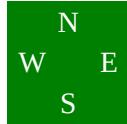
♣ 8 4

♠ Q 10 3

♥ K 10 6

♦ A 9 4

♣ 10 7 5 2



♠ 6

♥ Q J 7 4 2

♦ 6 3 2

♣ A 9 6 3

♠ K J 9 2

♥ A 9 8

♦ Q 10 8

♣ K Q J

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

Pass

1NT

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 5

After NORTH passes initially, SOUTH opens 1NT.

With 9 points, NORTH has invitational strength, so he says 2NT.

SOUTH has a small problem - NORTH's bid tells her to bid 3NT with 17 points, but to pass with 15 points. Her problem is that she has 16! Since it looks to her like a "good" 16 points she bids 3NT. If those 10's and 9's had been 4's and 3's she would have passed.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ K Q 10

♦ A J 7

♣ Q 10 8

♠ 6 2

♥ J 9 6 5

♦ Q 8 5 4

♣ 9 6 5



♠ A 7

♥ A 8 4

♦ K 10 6

♣ K J 7 4 2

♠ J 10 8 5 4

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 9 3 2

♣ A 3

WEST has a great 1NT hand - 17 points and 4-3-3-3 shape.

EAST has 16 points; he figures it is possible that WEST can make a slam, but only if she has a 17 point opener. So he bids 4NT, expecting WEST to bid 6NT if she has 17 points but to pass if she has fewer.

He figured right - WEST had 17 points so she bid 6NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			Pass
1NT	Pass	4NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			
6NT by West			
Lead: ♥5			

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 9 3
♥ J 4 3
♦ J 6 4 3
♣ 7 5

♠ A 7 4

♥ Q 9 6

♦ K Q 5 2

♣ K J 8



♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 7 2

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ K 8

♥ A K 5

♦ A 8

♣ Q 10 9 6 3 2

SOUTH definitely does NOT have a balanced hand.
She has two doubletons and a 6-card Club suit.

But she DOES have 18 points, (two extra for the fifth and sixth Clubs), and her 18 added to NORTH's minimum of 15 is enough to bid 6NT.

Notice how easy this will be to play once that Club suit is established.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥8